

write a book and it could get lonely. It is a good idea to work with someone with whom you are comfortable with. There are always exceptions (like Donald Knuth) who can write tomes on their own, but in general, partner with the *right* one(s).

Tip 3. Be prepared for rejections - but just move along!

Did you know that J K Rowling's Harry Potter series was rejected by 12 publishers? Agatha Christie struggled for five years before landing her first publishing deal! In general, be prepared for rejections from publishers. It's like attending job interviews - just move on.

Tip 4. Choose a topic that you are good at and are passionate about

Just because you are good at something doesn't mean you should write a book on it. If you are not passionate about the topic, the challenging task of writing the book will wear you out! Hence it is important to choose a topic that you are good at as well as something that excites and motivates you.

Tip 5. Write a book that is useful, helps people or makes a contribution

It could be teaching programming, a cook book, or just a bunch of tips and techniques. Ultimately, the book should help someone. Don't write a book just because you are an expert in that topic and want to write a book on it to get known.

Tip 6. Make sure your book has a USP (unique selling proposition)

A book is a product. A product gets an edge in the marketplace when it has a USP, which could be that it is the first book on the topic in the market, the only book on the subject, a novel approach to the topic, consolidates all the material in one book, is an easily accessible textbook that exactly matches the syllabus, etc.

Tip 7. Organise your thoughts using mind-mapping tools (and other available tools for writing)

Mind maps are especially effective in organising and streamlining your thoughts. Find and use such tools if they

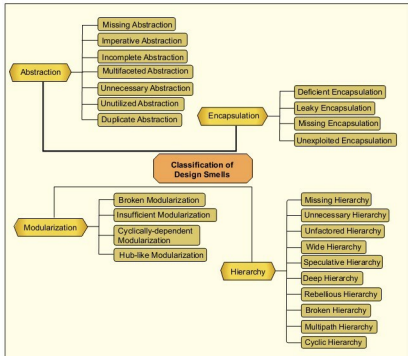


Figure 1: An example of a MindMap image from the author's latest book

work for you. Figure 1 shows one such mind map image that Tushar Sharma created for the book we co-authored, 'Refactoring for Software Design Smells: Managing Technical Debt'.

It can be both exhilarating and exhausting to write a book, but the rewards are worth the effort. So, what are you waiting for? Get a book idea, develop content and create a draft. And don't stop till your book goes out in the market. Then, promote it aggressively! 

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The author is a corporate trainer and independent consultant based in Bengaluru. He is a prolific writer and has written many books, articles and research papers. His latest book co-authored with Girish Suryanarayana and Tushar Sharma is 'Refactoring for Software Design Smells: Managing Technical Debt' published by Morgan Kaufmann/Elsevier, 2014. You can reach him through his website www.designsmells.com.

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